Excel Interview Preparation

Hindi + English Answers | Fresher Data Analyst | Concepts, examples, practical interview responses

Complete practice set: 39 questions with English answer, Hindi explanation, and examples where useful.

How to use this PDF

First understand the Hindi explanation, then practice saying the English answer aloud. For code/formulas, explain what each part does. Adapt project claims to what you actually built and verified.

Q1. What is Microsoft Excel?

English answer: Excel is a spreadsheet application used to organize, calculate, analyze, and visualize data.

Hindi explanation: Excel spreadsheet tool hai jisse data entry, calculation, analysis aur charts karte hain.

Q2. Workbook vs worksheet?

English answer: A workbook is an Excel file; a worksheet is an individual sheet inside it.

Hindi explanation: Workbook poori Excel file; worksheet uske andar ek sheet hai.

Q3. Cell reference types?

English answer: Relative references change when copied; absolute references use $ to lock row/column; mixed references lock one dimension.

Hindi explanation: A1 relative, $A$1 absolute, $A1 ya A$1 mixed reference hai.

Q4. What is SUM?

English answer: SUM adds numbers in a range.

Hindi explanation: Range ka total nikalta hai.

Example: `=SUM(B2:B20)`

Q5. What is AVERAGE?

English answer: AVERAGE returns the arithmetic mean of numeric values.

Hindi explanation: Numbers ka average nikalta hai.

Example: `=AVERAGE(C2:C20)`

Q6. COUNT vs COUNTA?

English answer: COUNT counts numeric cells; COUNTA counts non-empty cells.

Hindi explanation: COUNT numbers count karta hai; COUNTA non-empty cells.

Q7. What is IF?

English answer: IF returns one result when a condition is true and another when false.

Hindi explanation: Condition true/false ke basis par output deta hai.

Example: `=IF(C2>=3000,"Eligible","Not Eligible")`

Q8. What is IFERROR?

English answer: IFERROR returns a chosen fallback when a formula produces an error.

Hindi explanation: Formula error aaye to alternate output deta hai.

Example: `=IFERROR(A2/B2,0)`

Q9. What is SUMIF?

English answer: SUMIF sums values meeting one condition.

Hindi explanation: Ek condition ke basis par sum karta hai.

Example: `=SUMIF(A:A,"West",C:C)`

Q10. SUMIFS vs SUMIF?

English answer: SUMIFS supports multiple criteria; SUMIF supports one criterion.

Hindi explanation: Multiple conditions ke liye SUMIFS use hota hai.

Example: `=SUMIFS(D:D,A:A,"West",B:B,"Food")`

Q11. COUNTIF / COUNTIFS?

English answer: COUNTIF counts cells matching one criterion; COUNTIFS handles multiple criteria.

Hindi explanation: Condition match karne wali entries count karta hai; COUNTIFS multiple conditions leta hai.

Q12. What is VLOOKUP?

English answer: VLOOKUP searches the first column of a table and returns a value from a specified column to its right.

Hindi explanation: VLOOKUP first column me value dhundhkar right-side column ka result deta hai.

Example: `=VLOOKUP(A2,$H$2:$J$100,3,FALSE)`

Q13. What is XLOOKUP?

English answer: XLOOKUP searches a lookup array and returns a corresponding value; it can look left or right and has a not-found option.

Hindi explanation: XLOOKUP flexible lookup hai; left/right dono taraf return kar sakta hai.

Example: `=XLOOKUP(A2,H:H,J:J,"Not found")`

Q14. VLOOKUP vs XLOOKUP?

English answer: XLOOKUP separates lookup and return arrays and supports exact match by default; availability depends on Excel version.

Hindi explanation: XLOOKUP me lookup/return ranges alag dete hain aur exact match default hota hai; version support check karo.

Q15. What is INDEX MATCH?

English answer: INDEX returns a value at a position; MATCH finds the position, and together they form a flexible lookup.

Hindi explanation: MATCH position find karta hai, INDEX us position ka value return karta hai.

Example: `=INDEX(C:C,MATCH(F2,A:A,0))`

Q16. What is a PivotTable?

English answer: A PivotTable summarizes large data by categories using sums, counts, averages, and filters without writing formulas for each group.

Hindi explanation: PivotTable category-wise quick summary deta hai—sales by region, count by product.

Q17. What is a PivotChart?

English answer: A PivotChart visualizes a PivotTable and can respond to its field filters and slicers.

Hindi explanation: PivotTable summary ka linked chart hai.

Q18. What is a slicer?

English answer: A slicer is a visual filter for PivotTables or supported tables, making filtering easy for users.

Hindi explanation: Button-style filter jisse user category/region select karta hai.

Q19. What is conditional formatting?

English answer: It formats cells based on rules, values, or formulas to highlight trends and exceptions.

Hindi explanation: Rules ke basis par cells highlight karta hai, jaise low stock red.

Q20. What is data validation?

English answer: Data validation restricts allowed inputs, such as a dropdown list or numeric range.

Hindi explanation: Dropdown ya allowed range set karke incorrect entry reduce karta hai.

Q21. What is Remove Duplicates?

English answer: It removes repeated records based on selected columns; keep a backup and choose the key carefully.

Hindi explanation: Selected columns ke basis par duplicate rows remove karta hai; pehle backup rakho.

Q22. What is Text to Columns?

English answer: It splits text in one column into multiple columns using delimiters or fixed widths.

Hindi explanation: Comma/space jaise delimiter se ek column ko split karta hai.

Q23. What is Flash Fill?

English answer: Flash Fill detects a pattern from examples and fills remaining values, such as extracting first names.

Hindi explanation: Example pattern dekar names split/format karne me help karta hai.

Q24. What is Power Query in Excel?

English answer: Power Query imports and transforms data through repeatable steps, then loads results to a sheet or data model.

Hindi explanation: Excel me repeatable data cleaning/transform ke liye Power Query use hota hai.

Q25. What is Freeze Panes?

English answer: Freeze Panes keeps selected rows or columns visible while scrolling.

Hindi explanation: Scroll karte waqt header row/column visible rakhta hai.

Q26. What is a named range?

English answer: A named range assigns a meaningful name to a cell or range, improving formula readability.

Hindi explanation: Range ko name dekar formulas readable banate hain.

Q27. What is a formula vs function?

English answer: A formula is an expression entered in a cell; a function is a predefined operation used within a formula.

Hindi explanation: Formula complete expression; function Excel ka built-in operation hai.

Q28. How do you find blanks?

English answer: Use filters, Go To Special > Blanks, or COUNTBLANK depending on whether you want to inspect or count.

Hindi explanation: Filter/Go To Special se blanks identify, COUNTBLANK se count kar sakte hain.

Q29. How do you clean inconsistent text?

English answer: Use TRIM for extra spaces, CLEAN for non-printing characters, and consistent casing or mapping rules.

Hindi explanation: TRIM extra spaces, CLEAN unwanted characters remove karta hai; labels standardize karo.

Example: `=TRIM(CLEAN(A2))`

Q30. What is a dashboard in Excel?

English answer: An Excel dashboard combines KPI cards, charts, slicers, and concise layout to monitor performance.

Hindi explanation: Excel dashboard KPIs, charts aur slicers ko ek screen par combine karta hai.

Q31. How do you calculate percentage?

English answer: Divide part by total, handle zero totals, and format the result as Percentage.

Hindi explanation: Part ko total se divide karke percentage format lagao.

Example: `=IFERROR(B2/C2,0)`

Q32. How do you use date functions?

English answer: YEAR, MONTH, DAY, EOMONTH, and TODAY support date grouping and time-based analysis.

Hindi explanation: Date se year/month nikalna ya month-end find karna possible hai.

Example: `=MONTH(A2)`

Q33. What is sorting vs filtering?

English answer: Sorting changes row order; filtering temporarily displays rows meeting conditions.

Hindi explanation: Sort order change karta hai; filter selected rows hi dikhata hai.

Q34. How do you protect a sheet?

English answer: Protect Sheet can restrict editing of locked cells; it is not a substitute for secure file access controls.

Hindi explanation: Sheet protection accidental edits rokne ke liye hai, sensitive file security ka replacement nahi.

Q35. How do you handle a large dataset?

English answer: Convert to a Table, use Power Query or the Data Model, avoid volatile formulas where possible, and use PivotTables.

Hindi explanation: Table, Power Query/Data Model aur PivotTable use karo; heavy formulas optimize karo.

Q36. Explain Excel in your analytics workflow.

English answer: I use Excel for initial inspection, cleaning, quick calculations, lookup, pivot summaries, and validation before or alongside Power BI/SQL.

Hindi explanation: Excel se initial checking, cleaning, formulas, lookup, PivotTable aur validation karta hoon.

Q37. How do you check a dashboard is correct?

English answer: Compare totals to source data, test filters, inspect formula ranges, check duplicates/blanks, and validate sample records.

Hindi explanation: Source totals match karo, filters/formula ranges test karo aur sample records verify karo.

Q38. What is a common VLOOKUP error?

English answer: #N/A may mean no match; wrong column index or approximate match can return incorrect results. Use exact match and check data types/spaces.

Hindi explanation: #N/A match na milne se; wrong index ya approximate match se wrong output aa sakta hai. FALSE exact match use karo.

Q39. How would you present an Excel report?

English answer: Start with the business question, show a few KPIs and trends, explain filters and definitions, then state verified findings.

Hindi explanation: Business question se start, KPI/trend dikhao, definitions aur filters explain karo, verified insight batao.

Interview tip: If you are unsure of a detail, explain your understanding honestly and describe how you would verify it.